Drought; is fed at Cherith; goes to Zarephath; increases a Widow's Meal and Oil; raises her Son. Obadiah hunts for Water

of Gilead, said unto Ahab, [a] As Jehovah, the God of Israel, liveth, before whom I stand, [b] there shall not be dew nor rain these years, but according to my word. 2 And the word of Jehovah came unto him, saying, 3 Get thee hence, and turn thee eastward, and hide thyself by the brook Cherith, that is before the Jordan. 4 And it shall be, that thou shalt drink of the brook; and [c] I have commanded the ravens to feed thee there. 5 So he went and did according unto the word of Jehovah; for he went and dwelt by the brook Cherith, that is before the Jordan. 6 And the ravens brought him bread and flesh in the morning, and bread and flesh in the evening; and he drank of the brook. 7 And it came to pass after a while, that the brook dried up, because there was no rain in the land.

8 And the word of Jehovah came unto him, saying, 9 Arise, get thee to [d] Zarephath, which belongeth to Sidon, and dwell there: behold, [e] I have commanded a widow there to sustain thee. 10 So he arose and went to Zarephath; and when he came to the gate of the city, behold, a widow was there gathering sticks: and [f] he called to her, and said, Fetch me, I pray thee, a little water in a vessel, that I may drink. 11 And as she was going to fetch it, he called to her, and said, Bring me, I pray thee, a morsel of bread in thy hand. 12 And she said, [g] As Jehovah thy God liveth, [h] I have not a cake, but a handful of meal in the jar, and a little oil in the cruse: and, behold, I am gathering two sticks, that I may go in and dress it for me and my son, that we may eat it, and die. 13 And Elijah said unto her, Fear not; go and do as thou hast said; but make me thereof a little cake first, and bring it forth unto me, and afterward make for thee and for thy son. 14 For thus saith Jehovah, the God of Israel, The jar of meal shall not waste, neither shall the cruse of oil fail, until the day that Jehovah sendeth rain upon the earth. 15 And she went and did according to the saying of Elijah: and she, and he, and her house, did eat *many* days. 16 The jar of meal wasted not, neither did the cruse of oil fail, according to the word of Jehovah, which he spake by Elijah.

17 And it came to pass after these things, that the son of the woman, the mistress of the house, fell sick; and his sickness was so sore, that there was no breath left in him. 18 And she said unto Elijah, [i] What have I to do with thee, O thou [k] man of God? [1] thou art come unto me to bring my sin to remembrance, and to slay my son! 19 And he said unto her, Give me thy son. And he took him out of her bosom, and carried him up into the chamber, where he abode, and laid him upon his own bed. 20 And he cried unto Jehovah, and said, O Jehovah my God, hast thou also brought evil upon the widow with whom I sojourn, by slaying her son? 21 [l] And he stretched himself upon the child three times, and cried unto Jehovah, and said, O Jehovah my God, I pray thee, let this child's soul come into him again. 22 And Jehovah hearkened unto the voice of Elijah; [m] and the soul of the child came into him again, and he revived. 23 And Elijah took the child, and brought him down out of the chamber into the house, and delivered him unto his mother; and Elijah said, See, thy son liveth. 24 And the woman said to Elijah, [n] Now I know that thou art a man of God, and that the word of Jehovah in thy mouth is truth.

18 And it came to pass [o] after many days, that the word of Jehovah came to Elijah, in the third year, saying, Go, show thyself unto Ahab; and I will send rain upon the earth. 2 And Elijah went to show himself unto Ahab. And the famine was sore in Samaria. 3 And Ahab called Obadiah, [p] who was over the household. (Now Obadiah feared Jehovah greatly: 4 for it was so, [q] when Jezebel cut off the prophets of Jehovah, that Obadiah took a hundred prophets, and hid them by fifty in a cave, and fed them with bread and water). 5 And Ahab said unto Obadiah, Go through the land, unto all the fountains of water, and unto all the brooks: peradventure we may find grass and save the horses and mules alive, [2] that we lose not all the beasts. 6 So they divided the land between them to pass

[a] ch. 18. 10; 22. 14; 2 K. 5. 20
[b] ch. 18. 1; Lk. 4. 25; Jas. 5. 17
[c] ver. 9
[d] Obad. 20; Lk. 4. 26
[e] ver. 4
[f] Gen. 24. 17; Jn. 4. 7
[g] ver. 1
[h] 2 K. 4. 2–7
[i] 2 S. 16. 10; 2 K. 3. 13; Jn. 2. 4
[k] ch. 12. 22
[l] 2 K. 4. 34, 35; Acts 20. 10
[m] Heb. 11. 35
[n] Jn. 2. 11; 3. 2
[o] ch. 17. 1
[p] ch. 16. 9
[q] ver. 13

[1] Or, *art thou &c.* [2] Or, *and lose none of*

throughout it: Ahab went one way by himself, and Obadiah went another way by himself.

7 And as Obadiah was in the way, behold, Elijah met him: [a] and he knew him, and fell on his face, and said, Is it thou, my lord Elijah? 8 And he answered him, It is I: go, tell thy lord, Behold, Elijah *is here*. 9 And he said, Wherein have I sinned, that thou wouldest deliver thy servant into the hand of Ahab, to slay me? 10 [b] As Jehovah thy God liveth, there is no nation or kingdom, whither my lord hath not sent to seek thee: and when they said, He is not here, he took an oath of the kingdom and nation, that they found thee not. 11 And now thou sayest, Go, tell thy lord, Behold, Elijah *is here*. 12 And it will come to pass, as soon as I am gone from thee, [c] that the Spirit of Jehovah will carry thee whither I know not; and so when I come and tell Ahab, and he cannot find thee, he will slay me: but I thy servant fear Jehovah from my youth. 13 [d] Was it not told my lord what I did when Jezebel slew the prophets of Jehovah, how I hid a hundred men of Jehovah's prophets by fifty in a cave, and fed them with bread and water? 14 And now thou sayest, Go, tell thy lord, Behold, Elijah *is here*; and he will slay me. 15 And Elijah said, [e] As Jehovah of hosts liveth, before whom I stand, I will surely show myself unto him today.

16 So Obadiah went to meet Ahab, and told him; and Ahab went to meet Elijah. 17 And it came to pass, when Ahab saw Elijah, that [f] Ahab said unto him, Is it thou, thou troubler of Israel? 18 And he answered, I have not troubled Israel; but thou, and thy father's house, in that [g] ye have forsaken the commandments of Jehovah, and [h] thou hast followed the Baalim. 19 Now therefore send, and gather to me all Israel unto [i] mount Carmel, and [k] the prophets of Baal four hundred and fifty, and the prophets of [l] the Asherah four hundred, that eat at Jezebel's table.

20 So Ahab sent unto all the children of Israel, and gathered the prophets together unto mount Carmel. 21 And Elijah came near unto all the people, and said, [m] How long go ye limping between the two sides? [n] if Jehovah be God, follow him; but if Baal, then follow him. And the people answered him not a word. 22 Then said Elijah unto the people, [o] I, even I only, am left a prophet of Jehovah; but Baal's prophets are [p] four hundred and fifty men. 23 Let them therefore give us two bullocks; and let them choose one bullock for themselves, and cut it in pieces, and lay it on the wood, and put no fire under; and I will dress the other bullock, and lay it on the wood, and put no fire under. 24 And call ye on the name of your god, and I will call on the name of Jehovah: and [q] the God that answereth by fire, let him be God. And all the people answered and said, It is well spoken.

25 And Elijah said unto the prophets of Baal, Choose you one bullock for yourselves, and dress it first; for ye are many; and call on the name of your god, but put no fire under. 26 And they took the bullock which was given them, and they dressed it, and called on the name of Baal from morning even until noon, saying, O Baal, [1] hear us. But there was no voice, nor any that answered. And they [2] leaped about the altar which was made. 27 And it came to pass at noon, that Elijah mocked them, and said, Cry aloud; for he is a god: either he is musing, or he is gone aside, or he is on a journey, or peradventure he sleepeth and must be awaked. 28 And they cried aloud, and [r] cut themselves after their manner with [3] knives and lances, till the blood gushed out upon them. 29 And it was so, when midday was past, that they prophesied [s] until the time of the offering of the *evening* oblation; but there was neither voice, nor any to answer, nor any [4] that regarded.

30 And Elijah said unto all the people, Come near unto me; and all the people came near unto him. And [t] he repaired the altar of Jehovah that was thrown down. 31 And Elijah took twelve stones, according to the number of the tribes of the sons of Jacob, unto whom the word of Jehovah came, saying, [u] Israel shall be thy name. 32 And with the stones he built an altar in the name of Jehovah; and he made

[a] 2 K. 1. 6-8
[b] ch. 17. 1
[c] 2 K. 2. 16; Ezek. 3. 12, 14; Acts 8. 39
[d] ver. 4
[e] ch. 17. 1
[f] ch. 21. 20; Josh. 7. 25
[g] ch. 9. 9; 2 Chr. 15. 2
[h] ch. 16. 31; 21. 25, 26
[i] Josh. 19. 26; 2 K. 2. 25
[k] ver. 22
[l] ch. 16. 33
[m] 2 K. 17. 41; Mt. 6. 24
[n] Josh. 24. 15
[o] ch. 19. 10, 14
[p] ver. 19
[q] ver. 38
[r] Lev. 19. 28; Dt. 14. 1; Mic. 6. 7
[s] Ex. 29. 39, 41
[t] ch. 19. 10, 14; 2 Chr. 33. 16
[u] Gen. 32. 28; 35. 10; 2 K. 17. 34

[1] Or, *answer*
[2] Or. *limped*
[3] Or, *swords*
[4] Heb. *attention.*

a trench about the altar, as great as would contain [1] two measures of seed. 33 [a] And he put the wood in order, and cut the bullock in pieces, and laid it on the wood. And he said, Fill four jars with water, and pour it on the burnt-offering, and on the wood. 34 And he said, Do it the second time; and they did it the second time. And he said, Do it the third time; and they did it the third time. 35 And the water ran round about the altar; and he filled the trench also with water. 36 And it came to pass [b] at the time of the offering of the *evening* oblation, that Elijah the prophet came near, and said, [c] O Jehovah, the God of Abraham, of Isaac, and of Israel, let it be known this day that thou art God in Israel, and that I am thy servant, and [d] that I have done all these things at thy word. 37 Hear me, O Jehovah, hear me, that this people may know that thou, Jehovah, art God, [2] and *that* thou hast turned their heart back again. 38 Then [e] the fire of Jehovah fell, and consumed the burnt-offering, and the wood, and the stones, and the dust, and licked up the water that was in the trench. 39 And when all the people saw it, they fell on their faces: and they said, [f] Jehovah, he is God; Jehovah, he is God. 40 And Elijah said unto them, Take the prophets of Baal; let not one of them escape. And they took them; and Elijah brought them down to [g] the brook Kishon, [h] and slew them there.

41 And Elijah said unto Ahab, Get thee up, eat and drink; for there is the sound of abundance of rain. 42 So Ahab went up to eat and to drink. And Elijah went up to the top of [i] Carmel; and he bowed himself down upon the earth, and put his face between his knees. 43 And he said to his servant, Go up now, look toward the sea. And he went up, and looked, and said, There is nothing. And he said, Go again seven times. 44 And it came to pass at the seventh time, that he said, Behold, [k] there ariseth a cloud out of the sea, as small as a man's hand. And he said, Go up, say unto Ahab, [3] Make ready *thy chariot*, and get thee down, that the rain stop thee not. 45 And it came to pass in a little while, that the heavens grew black with clouds and wind, and there was a great rain. And Ahab rode, and went to [l] Jezreel: 46 and [m] the hand of Jehovah was on Elijah; and [n] he girded up his loins, and ran before Ahab to the entrance of Jezreel.

19 And Ahab told Jezebel all that Elijah had done, and [o] withal how he had slain all the prophets with the sword. 2 Then Jezebel sent a messenger unto Elijah, saying, [p] So let the gods do to me, and more also, if I make not thy life as the life of one of them by to-morrow about this time. 3 And when he saw that, he arose, and went for his life, and came to [q] Beer-sheba, which belongeth to Judah, and left his servant there. 4 But he himself went a day's journey into the wilderness, and came and sat down under a [4] juniper-tree: and [r] he requested for himself that he might die, and said, It is enough; now, O Jehovah, take away my life; for I am not better than my fathers. 5 And he lay down and slept under a juniper-tree; and, behold, [s] an angel touched him, and said unto him, Arise and eat. 6 And he looked, and, behold, there was at his head a cake baken on the [5] coals, and a cruse of water. And he did eat and drink, and laid him down again. 7 And the angel of Jehovah came again the second time, and touched him, and said, Arise and eat, because the journey is too great for thee. 8 And [t] he arose, and did eat and drink, and went in the strength of that food [u] forty days and forty nights unto [v] Horeb the mount of God.

9 And he came thither unto a cave, and lodged there; and, behold, [w] the word of Jehovah came to him, and he said unto him, What doest thou here, Elijah? 10 And he said, [x] I have been very jealous for Jehovah, the God of hosts; for the children of Israel have forsaken thy covenant, [y] thrown down thine altars, and slain thy prophets with the sword: and I, even I only, am left; and they seek my life, to take it away. 11 And he said, [z] Go forth, and stand upon the mount before Jehovah. And, behold, Jehovah passed by, and a great and

[a] Gen. 22. 9; Lev. 1. 7, 8
[b] ver. 29
[c] Ex. 3. 6; 4. 5
[d] Num. 16. 28–32
[e] Gen. 15. 17; Lev. 10. 1, 2; 2 K. 1. 12; Job 1. 16
[f] ver. 21, 24
[g] Judg. 4. 7; 5. 21
[h] Dt. 13. 5; 18. 20; 2 K. 10. 24, 25
[i] ver. 19, 20
[k] Lk. 12. 54
[l] Josh. 17. 16; Judg. 6. 33
[m] 2 K. 3. 15; Is. 8. 11
[n] 2 K. 4. 29; Jer. 1. 17; 1 Pet. 1. 13
[o] ch. 18. 40
[p] ch. 20. 10; 2 K. 6. 31
[q] Gen. 21. 31
[r] Num. 11. 15; Jer. 20. 14–18; Jon. 4. 3, 8
[s] Gen. 28. 11–15
[t] Ex. 24. 18; 34. 28; Dt. 9. 9–11, 18; Mt. 4. 2
[u] Ex. 3. 1; 4. 27
[v] Ex. 33. 21, 22
[w] Ex. 20. 5; 34. 14
[x] Rom. 11. 3
[y] Ex. 19. 20; 24. 12, 18

[1] Or, *a two-seah measure*
[2] Or, *for thou didst turn their heart backward*
[3] Or, *Yoke*
[4] Or, *broom-tree*
[5] Or, *hot stones*

strong wind rent the mountains, and brake in pieces the rocks before Jehovah; but Jehovah was not in the wind: and after the wind an earthquake; but Jehovah was not in the earthquake: 12 and after the earthquake a fire; but Jehovah was not in the fire: and after the fire [1] [a]a still small voice. 13 And it was so, when Elijah heard it, that [b]he wrapped his face in his mantle, and went out, and stood in the entrance of the cave. And, behold, [c]there came a voice unto him, and said, What doest thou here, Elijah? 14 And he said, [d]I have been very jealous for Jehovah, the God of hosts; for the children of Israel have forsaken thy covenant, thrown down thine altars, and slain thy prophets with the sword; and I, even I only, am left; and they seek my life, to take it away.

15 And Jehovah said unto him, Go, return on thy way [2] to the wilderness of Damascus: and when thou comest, [e]thou shalt anoint Hazael to be king over Syria; 16 and [f]Jehu the son of Nimshi shalt thou anoint to be king over Israel; and [g]Elisha the son of Shaphat of Abel-meholah shalt thou anoint to be prophet in thy room. 17 And it shall come to pass, that [h]him that escapeth from the sword of Hazael [i]shall Jehu slay; and him that escapeth from the sword of Jehu shall Elisha slay. 18 [k]Yet will I leave *me* seven thousand in Israel, all the knees which have not bowed unto Baal, and every mouth which hath not [l]kissed him.

19 So he departed thence, and found Elisha the son of Shaphat, who was plowing, with twelve yoke *of oxen* before him, and he with the twelfth: and Elijah passed over unto him, and cast [m]his mantle upon him. 20 And he left the oxen, and ran after Elijah, and said, [n]Let me, I pray thee, kiss my father and my mother, and then I will follow thee. And he said unto him, Go back again; for what have I done to thee? 21 And he returned from following him, and took the yoke of oxen, and slew them, and [3] [o]boiled their flesh with the instruments of the oxen, and gave unto the people, and they did eat. Then he arose, and went after Elijah, and [p]ministered unto him.

20 And [q]Ben-hadad the king of Syria gathered all his host together; and [r]there were thirty and two kings with him, and horses and chariots: and he went up and [s]besieged Samaria, and fought against it. 2 And he sent messengers to Ahab king of Israel, into the city, and said unto him, Thus saith Ben-hadad, 3 Thy silver and thy gold is mine; thy wives also and thy children, even the goodliest, are mine. 4 And the king of Israel answered and said, It is according to thy saying, my lord, O king; I am thine, and all that I have. 5 And the messengers came again, and said, Thus speaketh Ben-hadad, saying, I sent indeed unto thee, saying, Thou shalt deliver me thy silver, and thy gold, and thy wives, and thy children; 6 but I will send my servants unto thee to-morrow about this time, and they shall search thy house, and the houses of thy servants; and it shall be, that [4] whatsoever is pleasant in thine eyes, they shall put it in their hand, and take it away.

7 Then the king of Israel called all the elders of the land, and said, Mark, I pray you, and [t]see how this man seeketh mischief: for he sent unto me for my wives, and for my children, and for my silver, and for my gold; and I denied him not. 8 And all the elders and all the people said unto him, Hearken thou not, neither consent. 9 Wherefore he said unto the messengers of Ben-hadad, Tell my lord the king, All that thou didst send for to thy servant at the first I will do; but this thing I may not do. And the messengers departed, and brought him word again. 10 And Ben-hadad sent unto him, and said, [u]The gods do so unto me, and more also, if the dust of Samaria shall suffice for handfuls for all the people that [5] follow me. 11 And the king of Israel answered and said, Tell him, [v]Let not him that girdeth on *his armor* boast himself as he that putteth it off. 12 And it came to pass, when *Ben-hadad* heard this message, as [x]he was drinking, he and the kings, in the

[a] Job 4. 16; Zech. 4. 6
[b] Ex. 3. 6
[c] ver. 9
[d] ver. 10
[e] 2 K. 8. 8–15
[f] 2 K. 9. 1–10
[g] ver. 19–21; 2 K. 2. 9, 15
[h] 2 K. 8. 12; 13. 3, 22
[i] 2 K. 9. 14–10. 25
[k] Rom. 11. 4
[l] Hos. 13. 2
[m] 2 K. 2. 8, 13, 14; 1 S. 28. 14
[n] Mt. 8. 21, 22; Lk. 9. 61, 62; Acts 20. 37
[o] 2 S. 24. 22
[p] ch. 18. 43; 2 K. 2. 3
[q] ch. 15. 18, 20; 2 K. 6. 24
[r] ch. 22. 31
[s] ch. 16. 24; 2 K. 6. 24–29
[t] 2 K. 5. 7
[u] ch. 19. 2; 2 K. 6. 31
[v] Prov. 27. 1
[x] ch. 16. 9

1 Heb. *a sound of gentle stillness.*
2 Or, *by the wilderness to*
3 Or, *roasted*
4 Heb. *all the desire of thine eyes.*
5 Heb. *are at my feet.*

[1] pavilions, that he said unto his servants, [2] Set *yourselves in array.* And they set *themselves in array* against the city.

13 And, behold, a prophet came near unto Ahab king of Israel, and said, Thus saith Jehovah, Hast thou seen all this great multitude? behold, [a] I will deliver it into thy hand this day; and [b] thou shalt know that I am Jehovah. 14 And Ahab said, By whom? And he said, Thus saith Jehovah, By the [3] young men of the princes of the provinces. Then he said, Who shall [4] begin the battle? And he answered, Thou. 15 Then he mustered the young men of the princes of the provinces, and they were two hundred and thirty-two: and after them he mustered all the people, even all the children of Israel, being seven thousand.

16 And they went out at noon. But [c] Ben-hadad was drinking himself drunk in the [1] pavilions, he and the kings, the thirty and two kings that helped him. 17 And the young men of the princes of the provinces went out first; and Ben-hadad sent out, and they told him, saying, There are men come out from Samaria. 18 [d] And he said, Whether they are come out for peace, take them alive; or whether they are come out for war, take them alive. 19 So these went out of the city, the young men of the princes of the provinces, and the army which followed them. 20 And they slew every one his man; and the Syrians fled, and Israel pursued them: and Ben-hadad the king of Syria escaped [5] on a horse with horsemen. 21 And the king of Israel went out, and smote the horses and chariots, and slew the Syrians with a great slaughter.

22 And [e] the prophet came near to the king of Israel, and said unto him, Go, strengthen thyself, and mark, and see what thou doest; for [f] at the return of the year the king of Syria will come up against thee. 23 And the servants of the king of Syria said unto him, [g] Their god is a god of the hills; therefore they were stronger than we: but let us fight against them in the plain, and surely we shall be stronger than they. 24 And do this thing: take the kings away, every man out of his place, and put [6] captains in their room; 25 and number thee an army, like the army that thou hast lost, horse for horse, and chariot for chariot; and we will fight against them in the plain, and surely we shall be stronger than they. And he hearkened unto their voice, and did so.

26 And it came to pass [h] at the return of the year, that Ben-hadad mustered the Syrians, and went up to [i] Aphek, to fight against Israel. 27 And the children of Israel were mustered, and were victualled, and went against them: and the children of Israel encamped before them like two little flocks of kids; but [k] the Syrians filled the country. 28 And [7] [l] a man of God came near and spake unto the king of Israel, and said, Thus saith Jehovah, Because the Syrians have said, [m] Jehovah is a god of the hills, but he is not a god of the valleys; therefore [n] will I deliver all this great multitude into thy hand, and ye shall know that I am Jehovah. 29 And they encamped one over against the other seven days. And so it was, that in the seventh day the battle was joined; and the children of Israel slew of the Syrians a hundred thousand footmen in one day. 30 But the rest fled to [o] Aphek, into the city; and the wall fell upon twenty and seven thousand men that were left. And Ben-hadad fled, and came into the city, [8] [p] into an inner chamber.

31 And [q] his servants said unto him, Behold now, we have heard that the kings of the house of Israel are merciful kings: let us, we pray thee, [r] put sackcloth on our loins, and ropes upon our heads, and go out to the king of Israel: peradventure he will save thy life. 32 So [s] they girded sackcloth on their loins, and *put* ropes on their heads, and came to the king of Israel, and said, [t] Thy servant Ben-hadad saith, I pray thee, let me live. And he said, Is he yet alive? he is my brother. 33 Now the men [9] observed diligently, and hasted [10] to catch whether it

[a] ver. 28
[b] ch. 18. 36
[c] ver. 12
[d] 2 K. 14. 8–12
[e] ver. 13
[f] ver. 26; 2 S. 11. 1
[g] ch. 14. 23

[h] ver. 22
[i] 2 K. 13. 17

[k] Judg. 6. 3–5; 1 S. 13. 5–8
[l] ch. 17. 18

[m] ver. 23

[n] ver. 13

[o] ver. 26

[p] ch. 22. 25; 2 Chr. 18. 24
[q] ver. 23–26

[r] Gen. 37. 34; 2 S. 3. 31

[s] ver. 31

[t] ver. 3–6

[1] Or, *huts*
[2] Or, *Place* the engines. *And they placed* the engines
[3] Or, *servants*
[4] Heb. *bind.* [5] Or, *with horse and horsemen*
[6] Or, *governors* See ch. 10. 15. [7] Or, *the*
[8] Or, *from chamber to chamber*
[9] Or, *took it as an omen* (Heb. *divined*), *and hasted*
[10] Another reading is, *to catch it from him.*

were [1] his mind; and they said, Thy brother Ben-hadad. Then he said, Go ye, bring him. Then Ben-hadad came forth to him; and he caused him to come up into the chariot. 34 And *Ben-hadad* said unto him, [a] The cities which my father took from thy father I will restore; and thou shalt make streets for thee in Damascus, as my father made in Samaria. And I, *said Ahab*, will let thee go with this covenant. So he made a covenant with him, and let him go.

35 And a certain man of [b] the sons of the prophets said unto his fellow [c] by the word of Jehovah, Smite me, I pray thee. And the man refused to smite him. 36 Then said he unto him, Because thou hast not obeyed the voice of Jehovah, behold, as soon as thou art departed from me, a lion shall slay thee. And as soon as he was departed from him, [d] a lion found him, and slew him. 37 Then he found another man, and said, Smite me, I pray thee. And the man smote him, smiting and wounding him. 38 So the prophet departed, and waited for the king by the way, and [e] disguised himself with his headband over his eyes. 39 And as the king passed by, he cried unto the king; and he said, Thy servant went out into the midst of the battle; and, behold, a man turned aside, and brought a man unto me, and said, Keep this man: if by any means he be missing, [f] then shall thy life be for his life, or else thou shalt pay a talent of silver. 40 And as thy servant was busy here and there, he was gone. And the king of Israel said unto him, So shall thy judgment be; thyself hast decided it. 41 And he hasted, and took the headband away from his eyes; and the king of Israel discerned him that he was of the prophets. 42 And he said unto him, Thus saith Jehovah, Because thou hast let go out of thy hand the man whom I had devoted to destruction, therefore [g] thy life shall go for his life, and thy people for his people. 43 And [h] the king of Israel went to his house heavy and displeased, and came to Samaria.

21 And it came to pass after these things, that Naboth the Jezreelite had a vineyard, which was in [i] Jezreel, hard by the palace of Ahab king of Samaria. 2 And Ahab spake unto Naboth, saying, [k] Give me thy vineyard, that I may have it for a garden of herbs, because it is near unto my house; and I will give thee for it a better vineyard than it: or, if it seem good to thee, I will give thee the worth of it in money. 3 And Naboth said to Ahab, Jehovah forbid it me, [l] that I should give the inheritance of my fathers unto thee. 4 [m] And Ahab came into his house heavy and displeased because of the word which Naboth the Jezreelite had spoken to him; for he had said, I will not give thee the inheritance of my fathers. And he laid him down upon his bed, and turned away his face, and would eat no bread.

5 But Jezebel his wife came to him, and said unto him, Why is thy spirit so sad, that thou eatest no bread? 6 And he said unto her, Because I spake unto Naboth the Jezreelite, and said unto him, Give me thy vineyard for money; or else, if it please thee, I will give thee *another* vineyard for it: and he answered, I will not give thee my vineyard. 7 And Jezebel his wife said unto him, [n] Dost thou now govern the kingdom of Israel? arise, and eat bread, and let thy heart be merry: I will give thee the vineyard of Naboth the Jezreelite. 8 [o] So she wrote [2] letters in Ahab's name, and sealed them with his seal, and sent the letters unto [p] the elders and to the nobles that were in his city, *and* that dwelt with Naboth. 9 And she wrote in the letters, saying, Proclaim a fast, and set Naboth [3] on high among the people: 10 and set two men, base fellows, before him, and let them bear witness against him, saying, Thou didst [4] curse God and the king. And then carry him out, and stone him to death.

11 And the men of his city, even the elders and the nobles who dwelt in his city, did as Jezebel had sent unto them, according as it was written in the letters which she had sent unto them. 12 They proclaimed a fast, and set Naboth

[a] ch. 15. 20
[b] 2 K. 2. 3-7
[c] ch. 13. 17, 18
[d] ch. 13. 24
[e] ch. 14. 2
[f] 2 K. 10. 24
[g] ver. 39
[h] ch. 21. 4

[i] ch. 18. 45, 46
[k] 1 S. 8. 14
[l] Lev. 25. 23; Num. 36. 7; Ezek. 46. 18
[m] ch. 20. 43

[n] 1 S. 8. 14

[o] Esth. 3. 12; 8. 8, 10

[p] ch. 20. 7

[1] Heb. *from him.*

[2] Or, *a letter* [3] Or, *at the head of*
[4] Or, *renounce*

[1] on high among the people. 13 And the two men, the base fellows, came in and sat before him: and the base fellows bare witness against him, even against Naboth, in the presence of the people, saying, Naboth did [2] curse God and the king. [a] Then they carried him forth out of the city, and stoned him to death with stones. 14 Then they sent to Jezebel, saying, Naboth is stoned, and is dead. 15 And it came to pass, when Jezebel heard that Naboth was stoned, and was dead, that Jezebel said to Ahab, Arise, take possession of the vineyard of Naboth the Jezreelite, which he refused to give thee for money; for Naboth is not alive, but dead. 16 And it came to pass, when Ahab heard that Naboth was dead, that Ahab rose up to go down to the vineyard of Naboth the Jezreelite, to take possession of it.

17 And the word of Jehovah came to Elijah the Tishbite, saying, 18 Arise, go down to meet Ahab king of Israel, [b] who dwelleth in Samaria: behold, he is in the vineyard of Naboth, whither he is gone down to take possession of it. 19 And thou shalt speak unto him, saying, Thus saith Jehovah, Hast thou killed, and also taken possession? And thou shalt speak unto him, saying, Thus saith Jehovah, [c] In the place where dogs licked the blood of Naboth shall dogs lick thy blood, even thine. 20 And Ahab said to Elijah, [d] Hast thou found me, O mine enemy? And he answered, I have found thee, [e] because thou hast sold thyself to do that which is evil in the sight of Jehovah. 21 Behold, I will bring evil upon thee, and [f] will utterly sweep thee away, and will cut off from Ahab every man-child, and him that is shut up and him that is left at large in Israel: 22 and [g] I will make thy house like the house of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, and [h] like the house of Baasha the son of Ahijah, for the provocation wherewith thou hast provoked me to anger, and [i] hast made Israel to sin. 23 And of Jezebel also spake Jehovah, saying, [k] The dogs shall eat Jezebel [l] by the rampart of Jezreel. 24 [m] Him that dieth of Ahab in the city the dogs shall eat; and him that dieth in the field shall the birds of the heavens eat. 25 ([n] But there was none like unto Ahab, who did sell himself to do that which was evil in the sight of Jehovah, whom Jezebel his wife stirred up. 26 And [o] he did very abominably in following idols, [p] according to all that the Amorites did, whom Jehovah cast out before the children of Israel).

27 And it came to pass, when Ahab heard those words, that [q] he rent his clothes, and put sackcloth upon his flesh, and fasted, and lay in sackcloth, and went softly. 28 And the word of Jehovah came to Elijah the Tishbite, saying, 29 Seest thou how Ahab humbleth himself before me? because he humbleth himself before me, I will not bring the evil in his days; but [r] in his son's day will I bring the evil upon his house.

22 And they continued three years without war between Syria and Israel. 2 [s] And it came to pass in the third year, that [t] Jehoshaphat the king of Judah came down to the king of Israel. 3 And the king of Israel said unto his servants, Know ye that [u] Ramoth-gilead is ours, and we [3] are still, and take it not out of the hand of the king of Syria? 4 And he said unto Jehoshaphat, Wilt thou go with me to battle to Ramoth-gilead? And Jehoshaphat said to the king of Israel, [v] I am as thou art, my people as thy people, my horses as thy horses.

5 And Jehoshaphat said unto the king of Israel, Inquire [4] first, I pray thee, for the word of Jehovah. 6 Then [x] the king of Israel gathered the prophets together, about four hundred men, and said unto them, Shall I go against Ramoth-gilead to battle, or shall I forbear? And they said, Go up; for the Lord will deliver it into the hand of the king. 7 But [y] Jehoshaphat said, Is there not here a prophet of Jehovah besides, that we may inquire of him? 8 And the king of Israel said unto Jehoshaphat, There is yet one man by whom we may inquire of Jehovah, Micaiah the son of Imlah: but I hate him; for he doth not prophesy good concerning me, but evil. And Jehoshaphat said, Let not the king say so. 9 Then the king of Israel called an

[a] 2 K. 9. 26
[b] ch. 16. 29
[c] ch. 22. 38; 2 K. 9. 26
[d] ch. 18. 17
[e] ver. 25
[f] ch. 14. 10; 2 K. 9. 8
[g] ch. 15. 29
[h] ch. 16. 3, 11
[i] ch. 12. 30; 13. 34; 14. 16
[k] 2 K. 9. 10, 30–37
[l] 2 S. 20. 15
[m] ch. 14. 11; 16. 4

[n] ver. 20; ch. 16. 30–33
[o] ch. 15. 12; 2 K. 17. 12
[p] Gen. 15. 16; Lev. 18. 25–30
[q] 2 S. 3. 31; 2 K. 6. 30
[r] 2 K. 9. 25–37
[s] 2 Chr. 18. 2, &c.
[t] ch. 15. 24

[u] ch. 4. 13; Dt. 4. 43; Josh. 21. 38

[v] 2 K. 3. 7

[x] ch. 18. 19

[y] 2 K. 3. 11

[1] Or, *at the head of* [2] Or, *renounce*

[3] Or, *keep silence* [4] Heb. *to-day.*

[1] officer, and said, Fetch quickly Micaiah the son of Imlah. 10 Now the king of Israel and Jehoshaphat the king of Judah were sitting each on his throne, arrayed in their robes, in [2] an open place at the entrance of the gate of Samaria; and [a] all the prophets were prophesying before them. 11 And Zedekiah the son of Chenaanah made him [b] horns of iron, and said, Thus saith Jehovah, [c] With these shalt thou push the Syrians, until they be consumed. 12 And all the prophets prophesied so, saying, Go up to Ramoth-gilead, and prosper; for Jehovah will deliver it into the hand of the king.

13 And the messenger that went to call Micaiah spake unto him, saying, Behold now, the words of the prophets *declare* good unto the king with one mouth: let thy word, I pray thee, be like the word of one of them, and speak thou good. 14 And Micaiah said, [d] As Jehovah liveth, what [e] Jehovah saith unto me, that will I speak. 15 And when he was come to the king, the king said unto him, Micaiah, shall we go to Ramoth-gilead to battle, or shall we forbear? And he answered him, [f] Go up and prosper; and Jehovah will deliver it into the hand of the king. 16 And the king said unto him, How many times shall I adjure thee that thou speak unto me nothing but the truth in the name of Jehovah? 17 And he said, I saw all Israel scattered upon the mountains, [g] as sheep that have no shepherd: and Jehovah said, These have no master; let them return every man to his house in peace. 18 And the king of Israel said to Jehoshaphat, [h] Did I not tell thee that he would not prophesy good concerning me, but evil? 19 And *Micaiah* said, Therefore hear thou the word of Jehovah: [i] I saw Jehovah sitting on his throne, and [k] all the host of heaven standing by him on his right hand and on his left. 20 And Jehovah said, Who shall [3] entice Ahab, that he may go up and fall at Ramoth-gilead? And one said on this manner; and another said on that manner. 21 And there came forth [4] a spirit, and stood before Jehovah, and said, I will entice him. 22 And Jehovah said unto him, Wherewith? And he said, I will go forth, and [l] will be a lying spirit in the mouth of all his prophets. And he said, Thou shalt entice him, and shalt prevail also: go forth, and do so. 23 Now therefore, behold, Jehovah hath put a lying spirit in the mouth of all these thy prophets; and Jehovah hath spoken evil concerning thee.

24 Then [m] Zedekiah the son of Chenaanah came near, and smote Micaiah on the cheek, and said, Which way went the Spirit of Jehovah from me to speak unto thee? 25 And Micaiah said, Behold, thou shalt see on that day, when thou shalt go [5] [n] into an inner chamber to hide thyself. 26 And the king of Israel said, Take Micaiah, and carry him back unto Amon the governor of the city, and to Joash the king's son; 27 and say, Thus saith the king, [o] Put this fellow in the prison, and feed him with bread of affliction and with water of affliction, until I come in peace. 28 And Micaiah said, [p] If thou return at all in peace, Jehovah hath not spoken by me. And he said, [q] Hear, ye peoples, all of you.

29 So [r] the king of Israel and Jehoshaphat the king of Judah went up to Ramoth-gilead. 30 And the king of Israel said unto Jehoshaphat, [s] I will disguise myself, and go into the battle; but put thou on thy robes. And the king of Israel disguised himself, and went into the battle. 31 Now [t] the king of Syria had commanded the thirty and two captains of his chariots, saying, Fight neither with small nor great, save only with the king of Israel. 32 And it came to pass, when the captains of the chariots saw Jehoshaphat, that they said, Surely it is the king of Israel; and they turned aside to fight against him: and Jehoshaphat cried out. 33 And it came to pass, when the captains of the chariots saw that it was not the king of Israel, that they turned back from pursuing him. 34 And a certain man drew his bow [6] at a venture, and smote the king of Israel between [7] the joints of the armor: wherefore he said unto the driver of his chariot, Turn thy hand, and carry me out of the host; [u] for I am sore wounded.

[a] ver. 6
[b] Zech. 1. 18–21
[c] Dt. 33. 17
[d] ch. 18. 10, 15
[e] Num. 22. 18; 24. 13
[f] ver. 12
[g] ver. 34–36; Num. 27. 17
[h] ver. 8
[i] Is. 6. 1; Ezek. 1. 26–28; Dan. 7. 9, 10
[k] Job 1. 6; 2. 1; Dan. 7. 10
[l] Judg. 9. 23; 1 S. 16. 14; 18. 10; 19. 9
[m] ver. 11; Mt. 5. 39; Acts 23. 2, 3
[n] ch. 20. 30
[o] 2 Chr. 16. 10; 18. 25–27
[p] Dt. 18. 22
[q] Mic. 1. 2
[r] ver. 3, 4
[s] 2 Chr. 35. 22
[t] ch. 20. 1, 16, 24; 2 Chr. 18. 30
[u] 2 Chr. 35. 23

[1] Or, *eunuch*
[2] Heb. *a threshing-floor.*
[3] Or, *deceive*
[4] Heb. *the spirit.*
[5] Or, *from chamber to chamber*
[6] Heb. *in his simplicity.*
[7] Or, *the lower armor and the breastplate*

35 And the battle increased that day: and the king was stayed up in his chariot against the Syrians, and died at even; and the blood ran out of the wound into the bottom of the chariot. 36 [a] And there went a cry throughout the host about the going down of the sun, saying, Every man to his city, and every man to his country.

37 So the king died, and was brought to Samaria; and they buried the king in Samaria. 38 And they washed the chariot by the pool of Samaria; and the dogs licked up his blood ([1] now the harlots washed themselves *there*); [b] according unto the word of Jehovah which he spake. 39 Now the rest of the acts of Ahab, and all that he did, and [c] the ivory house which he built, and all the cities that he built, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel? 40 So Ahab slept with his fathers; and Ahaziah his son reigned in his stead.

41 [d] And Jehoshaphat the son of Asa began to reign over Judah in the fourth year of Ahab king of Israel. 42 Jehoshaphat was thirty and five years old when he began to reign; and he reigned twenty and five years in Jerusalem. And his mother's name was Azubah the daughter of Shilhi. 43 [e] And he walked in all the way of Asa his father; he turned not aside from it, doing that which was right in the eyes of Jehovah: [f] howbeit the high places were not taken away; the people still sacrificed and burnt incense in the high places. 44 And [g] Jehoshaphat made peace with the king of Israel.

45 Now the rest of the acts of Jehoshaphat, and his might that he showed, and how he warred, are they not written [h] in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah? 46 And the remnant of [i] the sodomites, that remained in the days of his father Asa, he put away out of the land. 47 And [k] there was no king in Edom: a deputy was king. 48 Jehoshaphat made [l] ships of Tarshish to go to [m] Ophir for gold: but they went not; for the ships were broken at [n] Ezion-geber. 49 Then said Ahaziah the son of Ahab unto Jehoshaphat, Let my servants go with thy servants in the ships. But Jehoshaphat would not. 50 [o] And Jehoshaphat slept with his fathers, and was buried with his fathers in the city of David his father; and Jehoram his son reigned in his stead.

51 Ahaziah the son of Ahab [p] began to reign over Israel in Samaria in the seventeenth year of Jehoshaphat king of Judah, and he reigned two years over Israel. 52 And he did that which was evil in the sight of Jehovah, and [q] walked in the way of his father, and in the way of his mother, and in the way of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, [2] wherein he made Israel to sin. 53 [r] And he served Baal, and worshipped him, and provoked to anger Jehovah, the God of Israel, according to all that his father had done.

[a] 2 K. 14. 12
[b] ch. 21. 19
[c] Am. 3. 15
[d] 2 Chr. 20. 31, &c.
[e] 2 Chr. 17. 3
[f] ch. 15. 14; 2 K. 12. 3

[g] ver. 2; 2 K. 8. 18; 2 Chr. 19. 2
[h] 2 Chr. 20. 34
[i] ch. 14. 24; 15. 12; Gen. 19. 5; Dt. 23. 17
[k] 2 S. 8. 14; 2 K. 3. 9
[l] ch. 10. 22
[m] ch. 9. 28
[n] ch. 9. 26
[o] 2 Chr. 21. 1

[p] ver. 40

[q] ch. 15. 26; 21. 25

[r] ch. 16. 30–32

[1] Or, *and they washed the armor*

[2] Or, *who made*